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Unit-3 One Shot + PYQs

Topics :-

- → Indian Religion (2 marks)
- * → pre vedic Religion (2 marks).
- → Vedic Religion.
- * → Buddhism
- * → Jainism — 2022-23
- → Six System of Ancient Indian philosphy.
- → Adi Shankaracharya.
- * → Bhakti Movement — 2021-22, 22-23
- * → Sufi movement
- → famous personalities.
- * → Modern Religious practices. — 2022-23

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AKTU- 2021-22 [2 marks]

Q. Discuss a short note on Indian Religion.

→ Religion is the science of soul. Morality and ethics have their foundation on religion.

→ Religion has been central to Indian life since ancient times

→ It tooks on various forms to suit different groups & their needs.

→ Indian spirituality is rooted in ancient philosphical & religious traditions.

→ Philosphy explained reality, while religion guided how to live

→ philosphy was the theoritical ascpt; religion was practical.

→ philosphy → Vision, Religion → fulfillment.

→ Philosphy and religion together offered a holistic approach to life, blending & action.

AKTU - 2022-23 (5th sem) - 2 marks.

Q. Define Pre-vedic Religion.

→ [Harappan Civilization & Religion]

* Origin - The Harappan civilization traces its roots to preceding rural cultures from Neolithic times, such as the Nal, Kulli, Zhob & Quetta Cultures.

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→ This civilization dates back to around 3000 B.C., matured around 2600 B.C., and declined around 1700 B.C.

→ Archeological evidance suggests that the most important aspect of pre-Vedic (Harappan) religion was the worship of the Mother Goddess or Nature Goddness.

→ Seals depict a female figure upside down with a plant emerging from her womb.

→ Male Deities - Shiva as a principal deity.

→ Harappan people possibly worshipped animals, as various animals are depicted on seals.

→ They also likely worshipped natural elements like water, fire, and trees depicted on seals and artifacts.

* Vedic Religion

→ The early vedic tradition was primarily maintained by priests, featuring a pantheon of nature deities.

→ The chief religious practice was sacrifice, involving specialized priests and the slaughter of animals.

→ purpose of sacrifices were rites of hospitality for the gods, performed to obtain material rewards on earth and in heaven.

→ Two Approaches.

① Pravrtti Lakshana - Characterized by action

② Nivrtti Lakshana - Characterized by renunciation

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Aims of Religion:

→ Abhyudaya: prosperity in this life and enjoyment in heaven in the after life.
→ Nihsreyasa: permanent freedom from all bondage and sufferings.

Vedic Texts:
→ Mantra: Serve the purpose of Abhyudaya.
→ Upanishads: Teach the ways and means for Nihsreyasa.

* BUDDHISM

→ Religion Buddhism was founded by Siddhartha Gautama (the Buddha) more than 2500 years ago in India.

Life of Gautama Buddha.

→ He was born at Lumbini in present-day Nepal.
→ He was the son of Shuddodana, the king of the Shakya gana of Kapilvastu.
→ Siddhartha was deeply affected by seeing an old man, a sick man, a dead body and a meditative sage, which made him question the nature of suffering and the true meaning of life.
→ At the age of 29, he left his royal life and went to the forests in search of the truth and the cause of suffering.
→ He achieved enlightenment at Gaya, on the banks of the Uruvela river, under a pipal tree.

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→ After enlightenment, he became known as Buddha. He decided to share his insights with others, teaching a simple code of conduct in the local language, pali.

→ He organized his followers into a monastic community called the Sangha, which followed specific rules and codes of conduct.

→ At the age of 80, Buddha passed away peacefully at Kusinagar (present day - Uttar pradesh).

* **Types of Buddhism** (Basis on geographical area)

① Theravada Buddhism - Thailand, Srilanka, Cambodia, Laos & Burma.
② Mahayana Buddhism - China, Japan, Taiwan, Korea, Singapore & Vietnam
③ Tibetan Buddhism - Tibet, Nipal, Mongolia, Bhutan & parts of Russia & nothern India.

Main Characteristics of Buddha Philosophy

→ Followers of Budelhism don't acknowledge a supreme god or deity. They instead focus on achieving enlightenment.
→ Buddha presented simple principles of life and practical ethics that people could follow easily.
→ Buddha considered the world as full of misery. Man's duty is to sick liberation from this painful world.

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→ Buddha's teachings are very practical and suggest how to attain inner peace from the material world.

JAINISM

→ Jainism is a very ancient religion. As per some traditions, it is as old as the vedic religion.
→ The Jain tradition has a succession of great teachers or Tirthankaras.
→ All the Tirthankaras were Kshatriyas by birth.

→ The first Tirthankaras is believed to be Rishabhanath or Rishabhadev. (Sign → Bull).
→ The 23rd Tirthankaras was Parshvanatha who was born in Varanasi (Sign → snake)
→ Founder of Jainism – Vardhaman Mahavira (540 – 468 BC)
→ Vardhaman Mahavir, the 24th Tirthankara, was born in 540 B.C. in a village called Kundagrama.
→ His father Siddharta was the head of the Inathrika Kshatriya clan.
→ He contributed a new principle of non-violence to the four principles, told by parshvanatha.

→ Due to his simple codes of conducts and use of people language, Mahavira could successfully propagated Jainism.
→ (Ardha - Magadhi)

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AKTU - 2022-23 [5th sem] 10 marks.

Basic principles of Jainism

1. Rejection of vedas and vedic Practices.
2. Self Control for Moksha
3. Immortality of the soul
4. Freedom from Actions for Moksha.
5. Belief in Equality.

The Vratas in Jainism

(A) Maha-Vrata.
- → Ahimsa - Avoid harming any living being.
- → Satya - Speak and promote truth
- → Asteya - Do not steal
- → Aparigraha - own only essential ~~truth~~ items.
- → Brahmacharya.

(B) Anu-Vrata - Soft version of the Maha-vrata.

(C) Guna-vrata → (1) Dig-vrata - limit the direc. in which trav.
(2) kal vrata - " " duration " " travel
(3) Anarth dandavrat - follow the ethical limits.

(D) Shiksha-Vrata → (1) Samayika - meditating regularly.
(2) proshadhopavasa - fast on specific days and stay in jain temples.
(3) Bhogopabhoga Parinama - Set daily limits on food & other pleasures.
(4) Atithi Samvibhag - share a portion of your cooked food with worthy guests.

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* Six System of Ancient Indian philosophy

→ The rational investigation of questions about existence, knowledge and ethics is called philosophy.
→ following are the summery on the six philosophical system of Indian philosophy:

(1) SAMKHAYA PHILOSOPHY -

→ One of the oldest Indian philosophies, propounded by Sage Kapila.
→ The 'term' 'samkhya' relates to enumeration and rational analysis.
→ Dualistic realism, two eternal realities: purusha (spirit) & prakriti (Nature).
→ Lost significance during the Gupta period.

(2) Yoga -

→ Attributed to Sage Patanjali
→ Yoga is a self-disciplining process of concentration & Meditation such as yogic practice leads states of Consciousness.
→ eight limbs of Yoga Sutras
Steps
① Yama (moral conduct)
② Niyama (discipline)
③ Asana (posture)
④ Pranayama (breathing)
⑤ pratyaya (Sensory withdrawal)
⑥ Dharana (Concentration)
⑦ Dhyana (meditation)
⑧ Samadhi (bliss).

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(C) Vaisheshika Philosophy

→ It was expounded by Sage 'Kanada'.
→ Everything is a combination of atoms, which remain after reducing material objects to their smallest parts.
→ Vaisheshika thinkers believe that all objects of the universe are composed of five elements – earth, water, air, fire and sky.
→ Living beings were rewarded or punished acc. to the law of karma.

(D) NYAYA philosophy

→ propounded by Gautama Rishi
→ focusses on logical reasoning and epistemology. Believes that ideas, beliefs, emotions, and visions depend on the mind.
→ Eliminate ignorance and spread knowledge to everyone.

(E) Purva Mimamsa philosophy

→ Attributed by Jaimini
→ means critical examination or solving a problem by reflexation.
→ Considers the Vedas as eternal and unchanging. Believes the world is without beg. or end & explains Dharma as duty.

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(F) Vedanta

→ Expounded by Badarayana
→ Based on Vedanta Sutra & Brahma Sutra. (Text)
→ dealing with the nature of reality and the self.

* Jagad guru Adi Shankaracharya

→ Adi Shankaracharya consolidated the doctrine of Advaita Vedanta.
→ wrote Commentaries on the Upanishads, Brahmasutras and Bhagavad Gita.
→ His philosphy Advaita Vedanta emphasizes one ultimate reality.
→ Bharman is true, the world is an illusion.
→ Bharman is unchanging & the highest truth.
→ Shankara traveled across the Indian subcontinent, propagating his philosophy through debates.
→ He established the importance of monastic life as in the Upanishads and Brahma Sutra.

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AKTU - 2021-22, 2022-23

Bhakti Movement

→ The Bhakti movement was a nationwide mass movement
→ Contributed to reduce the conflicts of Hindu-Muslim religion.
→ It gave a right direction to Indian culture and Society.
→ Establishment of classless egalitarian society.

Reason for the Bhakti movement

→ Bhakti movement was the predominance of bigotry, polythism and rituals in Hinduism.
→ Coming of sufi saints & other Hindu saints into Contact for avoiding the defects of bigotry.
→ Show the right path of devotion.
→ Create a sense of social, religious and equality in the mind of the people.

Objectives of Bhakti movement.

→ for removing the many flaws prevalent in Hinduism
→ because in Hinduism, there were many laws of worship, fasting, rituals which were difficult.
→ main objective is to remove the discrimination in Hinduism.

Head of Devotional movement.

→ Swami Ramanujacharya, Swami Ramanand, kabir, Guru Nanakji, Namdev, Tulsidas etc.

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Impact of Bhakti movement

→ emphasized the equality of human beings while removing caste discrimination.
→ formulated Hindu-Muslim unity.
→ Increased respect for lower class.
→ Karmakand spread by Brahmins
→ Hindus & Muslims both started being natamastak in each other's worship & religious ceremonies.

* Sufi movement

→ Just as the Bhakti-movement started among the Hindus, in the same way Sufism emerged on the basis of love-devotion among moslims.
→ different opinions of different scholars on where the word sufi originated.
① Sufi → safa → life of purity & sacrifice.
② Sufi → Sufa → wool
③ Sufi → Sophia → Knowledge.
→ Sufis are those who are concerned with the simplicity, purity, equality & generosity of Islam
Sufis two main streams
① Vajudia → kept distance from radical Islam, they did not promote Islam.
② Saudia → much closer to orthodox Islam, promote Islam.
→ Started in 12th Century & popular in 13th Century.

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→ main theme was "wahadut-ul-wajud" means Unity of God.
→ The first Sufi Saint was Begum Rabia of Bashera in Iraq.

Features

→ Sufis derived its inspiration from Islam.
→ Emphasized upon leading a simple life.
→ Sufi saints seeks inner purity
→ Devotion is more important than Roza (fast) or Namaz (prayer).
→ Salvation through love for God.
→ The Sufis were divided into 12 orders.
→ did not believe in caste system.

* Some famous personalities

① Raja Rammohan Roy - Spread the modern education, Scienc & technology.
② R.G Bhandarkar & M.G. Ranade - promote inter-caste marriages & freedom for women.
③ Swami Dayanand Saraswati - founded the Arya Samaj, fought against untouchability and caste rigidity.
④ Sayyid Ahmad Khan - encouraged Muslims to adopt modern education, also speak about purdah system.

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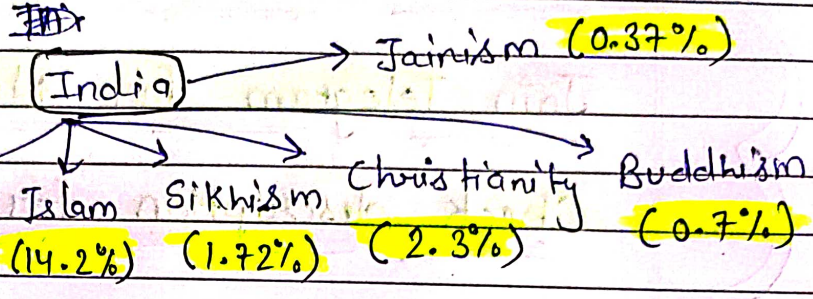
AKT (Unit 2 Part 3) (5th Sem)

Q. Define Modern religious practices

→ Religion has been a significant part of India's culture throughout its history. Acc. to 2011 census.



1. Hinduism → most widely practiced religion in India, is diverse and often seen as an umbrella term for various religions and traditions.

2. Islam → It is the second most followed religion in India.

3. Sikhism → Originated in India, promotes devotion to a formless God and emphasizes service, humility & equality.

4. Buddhism → focusing on a universal ethics rather than caste-based ethics.
→ follow the Buddha teachings.

5. Jainism → Strongly upholds the principles of 'ahimsa' (non-violence)
→ promotes vegetarianism & animal welfare.

6. Christianity → Third most followed religion in India, mostly concentrated in the far South and Mumbai.

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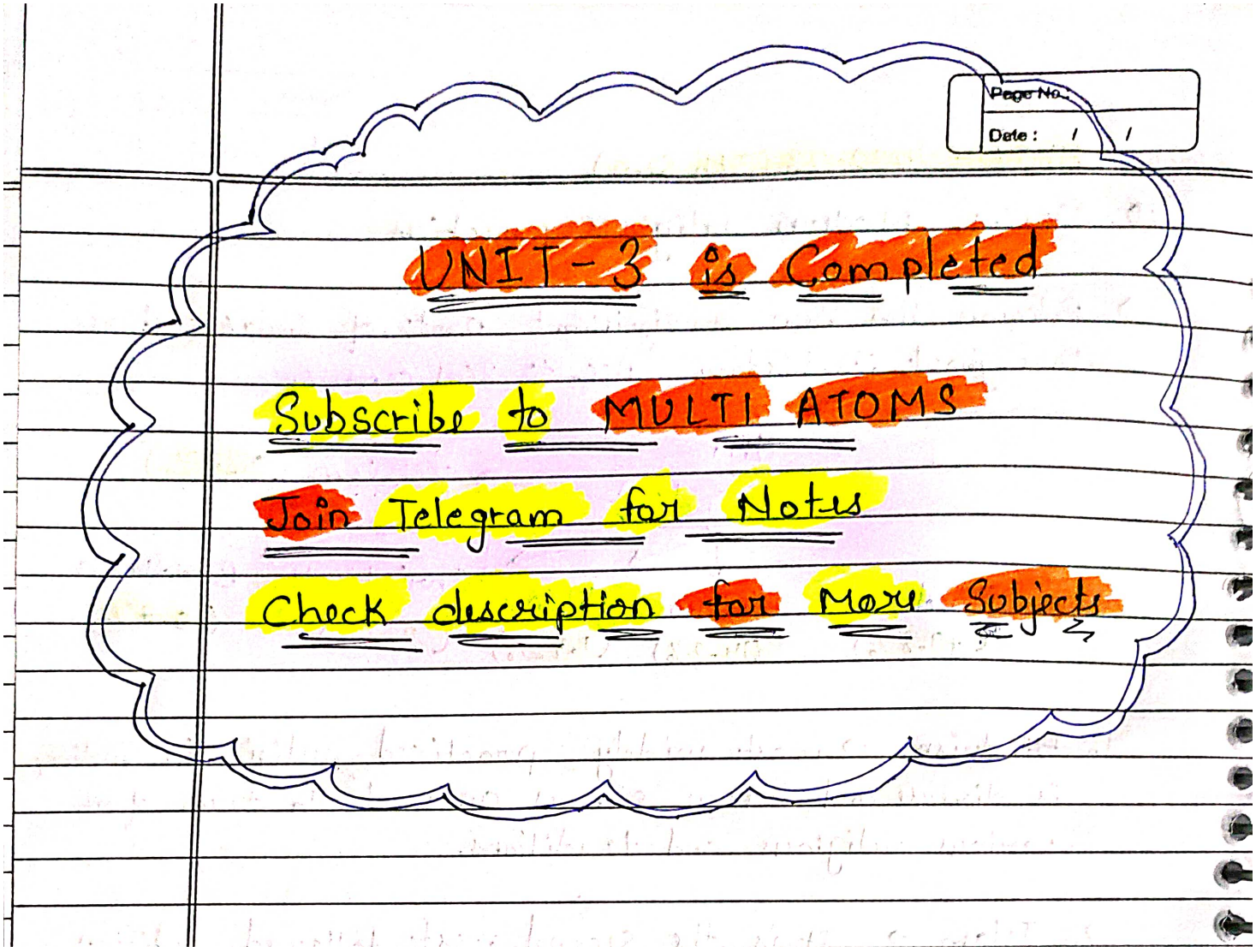

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